Media Guide — Sizes, Ratios & Metadata

Studio Rise Pilates — reference for replacement media

Everything in `public/media/` is used as a **full-viewport, parallax background**. The site renders each section at `100dvh` and stretches the media with `object-fit: cover; object-position: center` (see `ParallaxSection.astro` and `src/styles/global.css` → `.p-media`). The media layer is `200%` tall so it can travel during the parallax scroll without exposing an edge.

> **Net effect:** the visible frame is always the **centre crop** of the source file. Nothing near the edges survives on every device — and on phones (portrait) the horizontal crop is severe. Compose centre-forward.

1. The one rule that matters

Put the subject dead-centre, and keep all important content inside the middle ~40% of the frame (both axes). Treat the outer ~30% on every side as bleed that will be cropped away on smaller/narrower screens.

A full-body figure, a reformer, or a face placed at an edge will be chopped off on mobile. Centre it.

2. Images (`*.jpg`)

Currently: `1920 × 1280` (3:2) JPEG.

Property	Minimum	Recommended
Width	2560 px	3840 px
Ratio	3:2 or 16:9	3:2 or 16:9
Format	JPEG	JPEG (or WebP/AVIF)
Colour	sRGB	sRGB, embedded profile
Max size	500 KB	~300–400 KB

Why these numbers:

- **2560 px wide** covers a 2× (retina) desktop viewport (1920 CSS px × 2) with headroom for the parallax crop.
- **3840 px wide** covers 4K/retina desktops and gives the centre crop enough pixels to stay sharp on phones, where only the middle strip of the source is shown.
- **3:2 or 16:9** landscape is fine — the site crops to centre, so the ratio matters less than centring the subject. Avoid portrait sources: on desktop the centre-crop would discard their top and bottom, which is usually where the subject is.

Image export checklist

- □ Subject centred horizontally and vertically.
- □ ~30% safe bleed on all four edges (nothing important in it).
- □ JPEG quality ~75–82, progressive scan on.
- □ sRGB colour profile embedded (not Adobe RGB / Display P3).
- □ Orientation baked in (EXIF rotation applied — never rely on the EXIF flag).
- □ EXIF/GPS metadata stripped (privacy, and it trims file size).

□ Warm, consistent grade matching the palette (espresso / chalk / bone / almond).

3. Videos (`*.mp4`)

Currently: `1280 × 720` (720p) H.264, 24–25 fps.

Property	Minimum	Recommended
Resolution	1920 × 1080	3840 × 2160 (4K)
Ratio	16:9	16:9
Codec	H.264 (High, yuv420p)	H.264 + WebM (VP9)
Frame rate	24–30 fps	25 or 30 fps
Duration	10–20 s	10–15 s loop
Max size	8 MB	4–6 MB
Audio	**none**	**none**

Why:

- **720p is too soft** once the site crops to centre on a retina display. Full HD is the floor; 4K gives the centre crop real headroom.
- **16:9** is the universal video shape and matches the poster frames.
- **H.264 + yuv420p** plays everywhere (Safari included). Add a WebM/VP9 source only if you wire up `<source>` fallbacks — the current component uses a single `src`.
- **No audio track.** Videos autoplay muted; an audio stream is dead weight. Strip it during export.

Video export checklist

□ Muted / no audio track.
□ Seamless loop (first and last frames match, or the cut is invisible).
□ Subject centred; action stays within the middle ~40% of the frame.
□ No baked-in text, captions, logos or watermarks — the site overlays its own.
□ SDR, Rec.709 — no HDR (HDR files look washed-out when tonemapped).
□ Short (10–20 s); the loop repeats, so keep it clean and calm.
□ A poster image exported at the same 16:9 size as the video.

4. Posters (`*.jpg`)

Each video needs a poster (shown before playback, and on reduced-motion/slow connections):

- Same aspect ratio as the video (16:9).
- A representative, well-composed still from the video (ideally the first frame).
- Same export settings as images (sRGB, centred subject, ~300 KB max).
- Resolution: 1920 × 1080 minimum; 2560 wide recommended to match image specs.

5. Metadata to set / keep

Set in `src/data/content.json`:

- **`alt`** — every image should have a short, specific description. This is the accessibility text. Example already present: `"Woman practising Reformer Pilates in a bright studio"`.
- **`poster`** — every `type: "video"` media object must have a poster path.

Strip from the files themselves:

- **GPS / location** EXIF.
- **Camera/serial** EXIF.
- Any embedded ICC profile other than sRGB.

Keep correct:

- **Orientation** baked into pixel data (not an EXIF rotation flag).

6. File names & where they live

All media goes in `public/media/`, referenced from `content.json` as `/media/<name>`. Use kebab-case, lowercase, no spaces. Current references:

Reference	File	Type
`/media/hero.mp4`	`hero.mp4`	video
`/media/hero-poster.jpg`	`hero-poster.jpg`	poster
`/media/method.jpg`	`method.jpg`	image
`/media/classes.mp4`	`classes.mp4`	video
`/media/classes-poster.jpg`	`classes-poster.jpg`	poster
`/media/breathe.jpg`	`breathe.jpg`	image
`/media/visit.jpg`	`visit.jpg`	image

7. Quick reference

Use	Ratio	Min size	Format	Budget
Hero video	16:9	1920×1080	H.264 MP4	≤ 8 MB
Hero poster	16:9	1920×1080	JPEG	≤ 300 KB
Section image	3:2 / 16:9	2560 wide	JPEG	≤ 400 KB
centre subject, ~30% safe bleed, sRGB, no audio on video, EXIF stripped				